

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

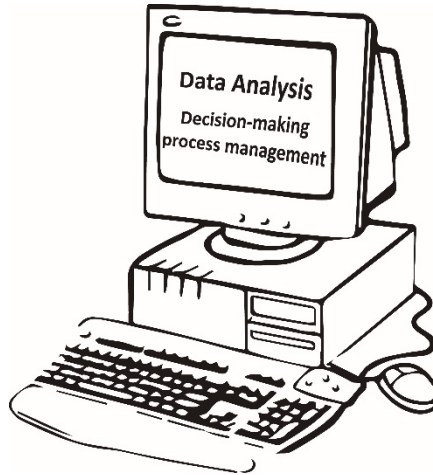
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Let's Start!

Decision Support System (DSS): Real Facts



Learning Outcome:

Describe common activities at work to a visitor using short sentences in familiar spoken and written situations.
Understand information about data and its structure in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think a support system is?
- Why is it important to express facts on technology in a written manner?

Can Do Statements:

- I can read about the Decision Support System.
- I can write meaningful sentences related to the Decision Support System.
- I can explain important facts related to the Decision Support System with correct sentences.



Let's Explore!

Let's learn some facts on DSS!



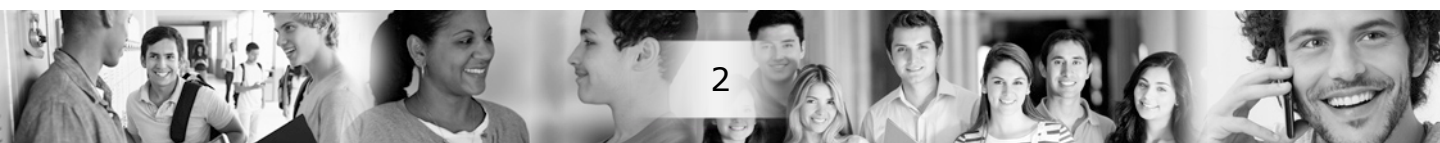
Instructions: Read the text below.

A Decision Support System (DSS) is a computer application; this application provides access to fundamental information. Companies can analyze this data in order to make decisions for their daily business. This is why we could also think of DSS as some kind of computer assistance to management.

We are going to have a careful look at this topic. Let's go back to the origins of DSS, back in the 1950's. Engineers were working on operational analysis and theory of organizations, and were developing the first interactive computer systems. Are you following the timeline?

What I want to clarify here is that people are working on the research and development of DSS nowadays, but this started some time ago. In the 60's, scientists started a more systematic and analytical research on DSS, and included the idea of "human-computer symbiosis" for problem solving. How much data can a Decision Support System store? We could think of a DSS as one or more large databases, whose data might be stored from transactions, online news services, and other sources. We are not going to mention all of them, because there are too many. Other tasks that DSS handles include data analysis, management of rule-based systems, and of interactive models. If the DSS of a company is well designed, the user can interact with all these elements with ease.

As you can see, Decision Support Systems are very useful computer applications that facilitate analytic and decision-making processes in a company. Businesses and companies have to understand the way a DSS could be used in their projects. Data management is a very important aspect when talking about investments and projects. We, as software developers, can't ignore the most important facts about this topic.





Let's Practice!

What were you saying about DSS, Miss?

Instructions: Write the words to correctly complete the sentences. Use words from the box below.

are going to have / following the timeline / are very useful to
/ not going to mention / provide access

1. DSS applications _____ to fundamental information.
2. We _____ a careful look at this topic.
3. There are too many applications, so we are _____
4. all of them.
5. Decision Support Systems _____ companies.
6. Are you _____ so far?



Let's Practice!

You could share this information with people learning about DSS.

Instructions: Match column A with Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Companies must analyze data
2. We could imagine DSS
3. Data stored in DSS can
4. We could think of DSS as
5. Companies have to understand how DSS
6. User interaction can be

COLUMN B

- a. a virtual management assistant.
- b. as a group of databases.
- c. easier with the help of a good DSS.
- d. from DSS to make better business decisions.
- e. come from transactions and online news services.
- f. can help them.



Extension Activity

Now that we learnt a little about DSS, let's do something practical.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find additional information about the use DSS in businesses, and some specific DSS software packages.
- Select the most important information, including the advantages of using DSS for companies
- Create a brochure on a piece of paper, in which you present the information you found. Remember to use modal verbs, simple and continuous structures to talk about DSS, its applications, and advantages.
- Present the brochure to your classmates, pretending you're selling them DSS as a product.

Self-Assessment

- | | Yes | No |
|---|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. I research about the business applications of Decision Support Systems. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 2. I collect relevant information on the subject of DSS in written form. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 3. I create a brochure in which I present the information I found and using specific structures of grammar. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 4. I present my brochure to the class as if I were a seller. | ☐ | ☐ |



Target Words

- **analytical** (adjective): using analysis
e.g. In the 60's, scientists started a more systematic and analytical research on DSS.
- **management** (noun): the process of managing something
e.g. Data management is a very important aspect when talking about investments and projects.
- **app** (noun): short form of "application". The use given to a computer program.
e.g. A DSS is a very useful computer app that helps analytic and decision making processes in companies.
- **symbiosis** (noun): a relationship that that involves dependence between two elements or entities
e.g. Research included the idea of "human-computer symbiosis" for problem solving.
- **transaction** (noun): something transacted; a business agreement
e.g. We should think of a DSS as one or more large databases that might be stored from transactions.
- **systematic** (adjective): using a system or method
e.g. Scientists started a more systematic and analytical research.



Learning Points

Review of Simple Present, Present Continuous, Be Going to in Affirmative, Negative and Questions

There are some very important tenses that we have to use in our daily life. Let's review some of them.

Simple Present:

We use the **simple present** to talk about permanent habitual facts in the present. Let's remember the structure of the **simple present**:

Subject (person animal or thing that performs an action) + verb (action performed)*
+ complement (object of the action, time, or/and place).

*Bear in mind that when you have a third person subject, the verb you use changes adding a final **"-s"**, **"-es"**, or **"-ies"**.

Examples:

We **work** on the design of apps for computers.

She **develops** applications.

For the negative and interrogative forms of the **simple present** tense, use the auxiliary verb **"do"** or **"does"** depending on the subject. Remember that whenever we use auxiliaries, the main verb does not change.

Examples:

Do you like these apps?

She **doesn't** understand what DSS is.

Present Continuous:

We use the **present continuous** to talk about actions that are happening at the moment of speaking, or/and temporary situations. The structure of the **present continuous** has the verb **"be"** and an action verb with **"ing"** at the end. To make the negative statement, we just have to add the particle **"not"** next to the verb **"be"**. Don't forget to conjugate the verb "be". Plus, you can be precise about the actual moment the event takes place.

Examples:

I'm working on my apps **at the moment**.

This year we're developing an amazing software system.





Learning Points

To make questions in the **present continuous**, we place the verb "**be**" (conjugated) before the subject. Just as in the simple present, only a **-wh** word can come before the verb "**be**".

Examples:

Are we **working** on the project now?

What colors **are** we **using** on this app?

We can also use the **present continuous** to express near future plans. Remember this is only for near future, for long term plans we use the going to.

Examples:

We're **finishing** the first app **tomorrow**.

We're not **working** next **Monday**.

Future with going to:

We use the **be going to** structure to talk about plans in the future.

Examples:

I'm going to design an app next week.

We are going to visit the client to collect requirements next month.

The structure of the **be going to** is quite similar to the one we use with the present continuous, with the difference that the **-ing** verb is always **going to** be going to to introduce an infinitive verb. To make the negative and interrogative forms, we add **not** to the verb **be** conjugated; and for questions, we put the verb **be** before the subject, just as we do in the present continuous.

Examples:

We **are not going to continue** with that project.

Why **are you going to quit** the app project?

Examples

- *A Decision Support System is a computer application, this application provides access to fundamental information.*
- *Are you following the time line?*
- *We are going to give a careful look at this topic.*



Learning Points

Review of Modal Verbs Must-Have to, Can - Could, in Affirmative, Negative and Questions

Modal verbs are auxiliary verbs that cannot work as the main verb in a sentence. They are used to express possibility, obligation, advisability, request, necessity and ability.

Grammar structure

Modal verbs cannot be the main verb of a sentence. They go along with it to express any of the functions stated above in the definition section. To use **modal verbs**, follow this structure:

Subject + modal + verb (bare form) + complement

Example:

I think we **cannot continue** using these computers. The whole system is getting very slow.

Advisability

It refers to the action of giving advice, recommendation and suggestions to those who need it. The **modal verbs** that are used for this are:

- should
- must
- could
- can
- had better

Examples:

To speed up the process of software design, you **should implement** technologies with easy access.

If you are really interested in software design, you **must use** this app.

Probability

Certainty and uncertainty have a lot to do with probability. Depending on how certain we feel about someone or something, we may use any of the **modal verbs** outlined below:

- will (certain)
- could (less certain)
- may (fairly more uncertain)
- might (the most uncertain)



Learning Points

Examples:

Sahra sent me an e-mail. She says she **will be** in the meeting today.

He said he has too much office work. In case he can solve some urgent issues, he **might attend** the meeting.

Obligation

Companies, schools, colleges and other conglomerate institutions have rules and procedures that employees have to obey. To achieve goals we must also enforce ourselves with discipline and constancy. The **modal verbs** we use to express obligation are:

- have to (external imposition)
- have got to (external imposition)
- must (personal imposition)

Examples:

We **have to enter** a double password to get access to any project content of the company.

I **must use** the security password if I want to enter any content.

Ability

In order to state what we are capable of doing with our personal skills, knowledge, experience and talents, we use:

- can (present abilities)
- could (past abilities)
- will be able to (future abilities)

Examples:

For some time I **could write** code, but I've forgotten.

I **can make** companies save money by designing an app.

Examples

- *How much data can a Decision Support System store?*
- *We should think of a DSS as one or more large databases.*
- *All these elements must help the user explore different alternatives if the DSS is well designed.*